OXFORDSHIRE COUNTY COUNCIL

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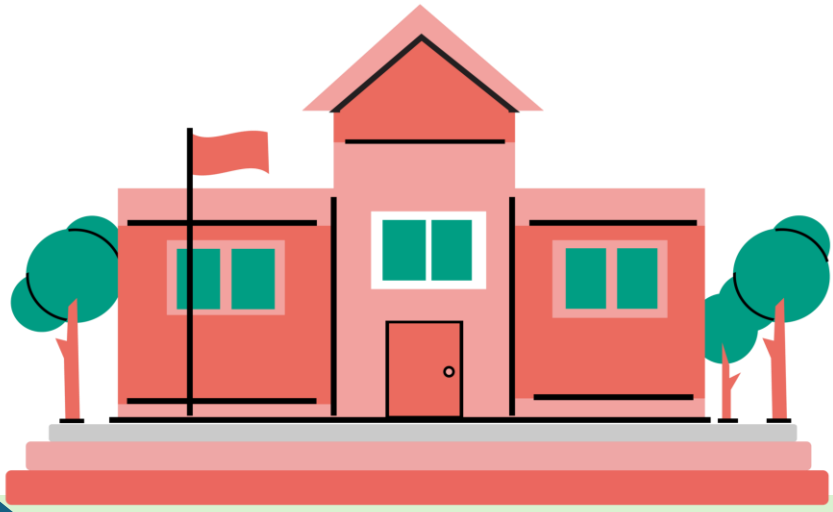
Oxfordshire Educational Psychology Service

Working with an Educational Psychologist:

Information for parents/carers



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What are Educational Psychologists?

Educational Psychologists support children and young people aged 0–25 with SEND by working with schools and settings to improve learning and well-being. We help with difficulties in learning, communication, social interaction, and emotional or sensory needs.

What does an Educational Psychologist do?

With the schools/settings that opt-in to our service, we use a Joint Problem Solving (JPS) approach. This means the EP meets with the adults who know the child best—such as school staff and parents—to have a collaborative conversation.

During JPS, we explore:

- What is going well
- What is causing concern
- What might help next

By the end of the meeting, there should always be agreed strategies, or a new shared understanding of the child's situation

What might an EP do when working with your child, you and the school?

EP involvement can include:

- Talking with school staff, parents/carers, and other professionals to build a full picture of a child's needs.
- Observing children in the classroom or playground to understand how they learn and play.
- Spending time working directly with individual children to see how they learn and gain their views.
- Helping schools choose and set up the right support or interventions for a child or group of children.
- Offering advice or training to school staff on areas relevant to your child's SEND.
- Taking part in meetings with other agencies to ensure joined-up support for children and families.

If you think an EP could be helpful?

If you have concerns about your child, speak with the school's SENDCo. They will consider what support may help and, if appropriate, contact our service if they opt-in to it. Where EP work is agreed, parents/carers will always be asked to give consent.

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What if I have any follow up questions for the EP?

The EP will be happy to discuss any questions you may have following their visit to the school/setting. There is also an online survey link that you will receive following EP involvement where you can share any feedback.

What if I want to find out more?

You can find out more about us by talking to your school's SENDCo. If you have any further queries, please contact us:

educationalpsychologycentral@oxfordshire.gov.uk

There is more information available on our website:

Family Information Service | Oxfordshire County Council
Educational Psychology Service

Committed to working in partnership with parents and carers.